

The Certification Process

How certification works with ABS — from first conversation to certificate and beyond.

Overview

Certification follows a well-established route defined by ISO/IEC 17021-1. It runs in four phases — scoping, a Stage 1 audit, a Stage 2 audit, and certification followed by ongoing surveillance. For most organisations under 200 employees the journey is around 10-14 weeks.

1. Scoping & quote

We agree your scope, standard, sites and complexity, then send a fixed-price proposal within 24 hours. Nothing else begins until you are comfortable with the scope and cost.

2. Stage 1 audit

A documentation and readiness review: your policies, scope and readiness are checked, and any gaps are surfaced early. Often conducted remotely.

3. Stage 2 audit

An implementation assessment: the auditor gathers evidence across your operations — interviews, records and observation — to confirm the system works in practice.

4. Certification & surveillance

Once findings are closed, an independent certification decision is made and your certificate is issued — recognised internationally through our accreditation. Surveillance audits (typically annual) and a recertification at the end of the three-year cycle keep it credible.